

MENU



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Daniel Arnold is Emboldened to Fail While Holding New York's Hand

Danielle Gang

It is a sweltering 95 degrees, and Daniel Arnold is waiting for us outside of his building to ensure we find it. As we shake hands and make introductions, he tells us that people often get routed around the block. We cool our hands on the metal bannister and chat about our days as Daniel leads us upstairs. We enter his airy apartment, adorned with art, relics, streetwear, and lots of books. The space opens upward into lofted ceilings, a beam hung with film, centering on enormous, Venetian-style windows overlooking the East River and a sherbet sky. I want to say that the apartment is like a globe, but stop myself. Where my relationship to attention involves extracting meaning, or narrativizing what I see, Daniel's seems to be about inhabiting it without needing to define it.

He tells us to sit anywhere we'd like, motioning to chairs, stools, and a bed. I plop down on the floor, where Daniel joins me shortly.

He grew up in Milwaukee, raised by a mother from Westchester and a father from Wisconsin, and I'm curious to know how his upbringing shaped the stories he values. Daniel says that, at forty six, his upbringing is still happening.

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